

MATRIMORPHOSIS – 2026

ASSIGNMENT 1

**What happens when I visit the
Google homepage from my mobile
browser?**

Name : Shahnaz Shafreen S
College : Bannari Amman Institute of Technology
Department : Computer Science and Engineering
Batch : 2023 - 2027
Email ID : shafreenshahnaz@gmail.com
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1. Introduction

When we open a web browser on a mobile phone and enter `www.google.com`, the Google homepage appears within a few seconds. Although this looks like a simple action to the user, several operations take place in the background before the webpage becomes visible.

The journey involves multiple components working together, including the mobile browser, operating system, network connection, DNS services, routers, servers, and the Google application infrastructure. The browser first processes the user's input and prepares a request. The request then travels through the network to reach the appropriate Google servers. The servers process the request and send the required resources back to the mobile device.

Once the response reaches the device, the browser processes the received data and constructs the webpage that is displayed on the screen. Additional resources such as HTML, CSS, JavaScript, images, fonts, and other files may also be requested and processed during this process.

This assignment attempts to break down this complete journey into as many meaningful operations as possible. The operations are grouped into four major stages: client-side request handling, network operations, server-side operations, and client-side response handling.

Understanding this process provides a high-level view of how a modern web application works from the moment a user enters a web address until the final webpage is rendered on the screen.

The process also depends on several supporting services that work together to complete the request. The browser communicates with the operating system and network before the request reaches the destination server. DNS helps identify the server associated with the website address, while network devices forward the request toward it. After processing the request, the server sends the required data back to the device. The browser then receives these resources, processes them, and renders the final webpage for the user.

2. Objectives

- To understand what happens behind the scenes when a user enters a website address in a mobile browser.
- To identify the different components involved in processing a web request, including the browser, operating system, network, DNS services, and servers.
- To understand how a request travels from the mobile device through the network and reaches the appropriate server.
- To understand how the server processes the request and sends the required response and resources back to the client.
- To understand how the browser processes the received response and renders the final webpage on the screen.
- To develop a high-level understanding of how the different components of a modern web application work together.

3. Assumptions

- First-time visit: The user is visiting www.google.com for the first time on the mobile device, so we consider the user to be a non-logged-in user.
- Internet connection: The mobile device has a stable internet connection and is able to communicate with external servers.
- Browser: The user is accessing Google using the Google Chrome browser on a mobile device.
- Normal device operation: The mobile device and its operating system are assumed to be functioning normally without any hardware or software issues.
- No unusual conditions: Network failures, server errors, cached content, and other exceptional conditions are not considered in this analysis.
- Browser settings: The browser is assumed to have its normal settings enabled, allowing it to send requests and receive the required webpage resources.

4. Operations

The complete journey from entering the website address to displaying the Google homepage involves several operations across the client device, network, servers, and browser. These operations can be divided into four stages based on where the processing takes place. The following sections describe the steps involved in each stage in a logical sequence.

4.1 Client-side Operations (Request Handling)

Client-side request handling includes the operations performed by the mobile device, operating system, and browser before the request reaches the external network. These operations begin when the user enters the website address and continue until the browser sends the request for further processing.

- 1. Opening the browser:** The user opens the Google Chrome browser on the mobile device.
- 2. Loading the browser interface:** Chrome initializes its interface and prepares the required browser components.
- 3. Entering the URL:** The user enters `www.google.com` in the address bar.
- 4. Identifying the input:** The browser recognizes that the entered text is a website address rather than a search query.
- 5. Processing the URL:** The browser separates the different parts of the URL, such as the protocol and domain name.
- 6. Checking browser information:** The browser checks its available information to determine whether any relevant data about the requested website is already known.
- 7. Preparing the request:** The browser prepares a network request for the requested website.

8. Determining the communication method: The browser determines the appropriate secure communication method for connecting to the website.

9. Interacting with the operating system: Chrome requests the mobile operating system to provide the required network communication facilities.

10. Preparing network access: The operating system prepares the device's network interface to communicate with the external network.

11. Selecting the active connection: The device uses its available internet connection, such as Wi-Fi or mobile data.

12. Creating the outgoing data: The browser and operating system prepare the information that needs to be transmitted to the destination.

13. Passing the request to the network layer: The operating system passes the prepared network information to the appropriate networking components.

14. Sending the request: The request leaves the mobile device and begins its journey through the network toward Google's infrastructure.

4.2 Network Operations

Network operations begin after the browser prepares the request. The mobile device uses the available internet connection to send the request toward Google's infrastructure. Several network components work together to deliver the request to the correct destination.

1. Establishing the network connection: The mobile device uses Wi-Fi or mobile data to establish communication with the internet.

2. Passing the request to the network: The operating system passes the prepared request to the appropriate networking components.

3. Resolving the domain name: DNS translates `www.google.com` into an IP address that identifies the appropriate destination.

4. Preparing network packets: The request is divided into smaller packets so that it can be transmitted efficiently across the network.

5. Passing through the router: The packets reach the router, which determines where they should be forwarded next.

6. Forwarding through the ISP: The internet service provider carries the packets from the user's network toward the wider internet.

7. Reaching Google's network: The packets travel through multiple network devices and eventually reach Google's network infrastructure.

8. Selecting the destination: Google's network directs the incoming request toward the appropriate server or service that can process it.

4.3 Server-side Operations (Request Processing)

Once the request reaches Google's infrastructure, it is processed by the server-side components. The servers determine what content is required, retrieve the necessary resources, and prepare a response that can be sent back to the mobile device.

1. Receiving the request: The appropriate Google server receives the request from the network.

2. Checking the request: The server examines the incoming request to understand the requested website and the required resources.

3. Processing the request: The server processes the request and determines what information should be returned to the user.

4. Identifying required resources: The server identifies resources such as HTML, CSS, JavaScript, images, fonts, and other files required for the webpage.

5. Retrieving the resources: The required resources are obtained from the appropriate storage systems or services.

6. Preparing the response: The server organizes the requested information and prepares it as an HTTP response.

7. Sending the response: The completed response is sent from Google's infrastructure back through the network toward the user's mobile device.

4.4 Client-side Response Handling

After the server processes the request, the response travels back through the network to the mobile device. The browser then receives the response and performs several operations to convert the received data into the webpage visible to the user.

1. Receiving the response: The mobile device receives the response sent by Google's server through the network.

2. Passing the response to the browser: The operating system delivers the received network data to the browser that initiated the request.

3. Processing the HTML: The browser reads the received HTML and identifies the structure and content of the webpage.

4. Requesting additional resources: The browser may request additional resources such as CSS files, JavaScript files, images, and fonts required by the webpage.

5. Processing CSS and JavaScript: The browser processes the received CSS and JavaScript to determine the appearance and behavior of the webpage.

6. Building the webpage: The browser combines the HTML, CSS, JavaScript, images, and other resources to construct the webpage.

7. Rendering the page: The browser converts the processed webpage into visual elements that can be displayed on the mobile screen.

8. Displaying the Google homepage: The completed Google homepage becomes visible to the user, completing the journey from entering the website address to viewing the webpage.

5. End-to-End Request Flow

The complete process involves several components working together across the mobile device, network, and Google's infrastructure. The following sequence summarizes the journey from the user's action to the final webpage.

1. User action: The user opens the mobile browser and enters `www.google.com`.

2. Browser processing: The browser identifies the URL and prepares a request.

3. Network connection: The operating system sends the request through the available internet connection.

4. DNS resolution: DNS converts the domain name into the corresponding IP address.

5. Network routing: Routers and the internet service provider forward the request toward Google's network.

6. Server processing: Google's infrastructure receives and processes the request and identifies the required resources.

7. Response generation: The server prepares an HTTP response containing the requested webpage resources.

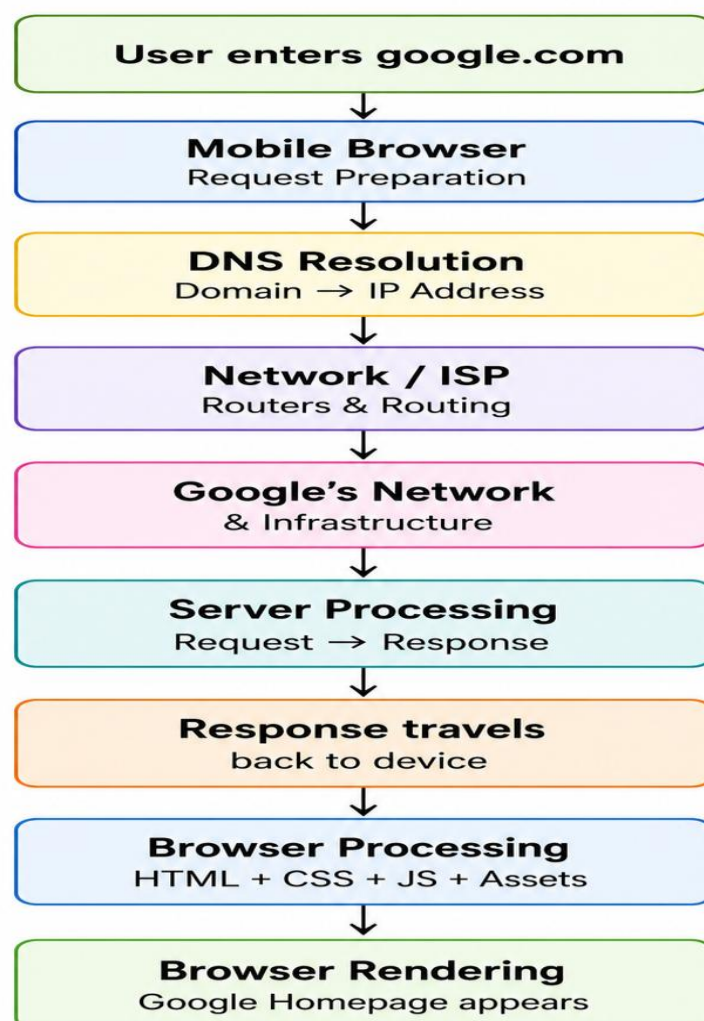
8. Response delivery: The response travels back through the network to the mobile device.

9. Browser processing: The browser receives the response, processes the HTML and other resources, and constructs the webpage.

10. Final rendering: The browser renders the completed webpage and displays the Google homepage on the mobile screen.

6. Overall Process Flow

The following flow represents the complete journey of a request from the user's mobile browser to Google's infrastructure and back to the browser. It combines the client-side, network, server-side, and response-handling operations described in the previous sections.



7. Developer Tools Observation

Developer Tools can be used to observe what happens when the Google homepage is loaded in a browser. The Network tab shows the requests sent by the browser and the responses received from the server. It displays information such as request type, status code, response time, and transferred resources. The Elements tab shows the HTML structure and CSS used to construct the webpage. The Console tab can display JavaScript messages and errors. These tools help in understanding how the webpage is loaded, processed, and rendered by the browser.

8. Detailed Request-Response Flow

The complete process can be understood as a sequence of request and response operations. When the user enters `www.google.com`, the browser prepares the request and uses DNS to identify the server's IP address. The request then travels through the network and routers until it reaches Google's infrastructure. After the server processes the request, the response is sent back to the mobile device. Finally, the browser processes the received HTML, CSS, JavaScript, images, and other resources and renders the Google homepage on the screen.

9. Conclusion

Visiting the Google homepage from a mobile browser involves several operations that happen within a few seconds. The process includes browser handling, DNS resolution, network communication, server processing, and response rendering. Understanding these steps provides a clear view of how different components work together to deliver a webpage to the user.

10. References

1. Google Chrome Developer Tools documentation – Network, Elements, and Console panels.
2. MDN Web Docs – HTTP, DNS, HTML, CSS, and JavaScript concepts.